

Unfortunately, this method is way too slow and cumbersome. Also, Photoshop can't interpret ActionScript code to let you preview results, and effectively you'd have to do some serious planning on how to code the image you intend to create. To ease this, Adobe introduced the FXG language to help solve this particular programming hassle. FXG, or Flash XML Graphics, is a graphics interchange file format based on XML that lets you define low-level vector graphics and specific attention is paid to how Flash Player renders graphics. Starting from Flex 4, you can declare FXG graphics either as part of an MXML file or by incorporating FXG files exported from Creative Suite products as embedded graphics.

Declaring vector graphics in MXML

FXG is basically an XMLbased declarative format that enables you to either declare vector graphics within an MXML file or exchange graphical declarations between software applications that support the format that is using FXG files. There are two versions of the FXG specification: versions 1 and 2. Starting with Creative Suite 4, Adobe's graphical authoring tools (Illustrator, Photoshop, and Fireworks) were able to import and export FXG files. In Creative Suite 4 (CS4), these software products work with FXG version 1, while the CS5 versions of these applications and the Flex 4.5 SDK supports both versions 1 and 2.

Note that you can define a vector graphic in text files with an FXG extension, or as an MXML-based declaration of ActionScript objects that are based on a set of classes. In either case, the graphics are rendered by Flash Player at runtime and are dependent on Flash Player's graphical rendering capabilities.

Drawing lines and shapes

In an FXG file, you can simply draw a shape by declaring an element with its name and then setting its required attributes. The FXG specification has the following elements defined

- `<Graphic>`
- `<Ellipse>`
- `<Line>`
- `<Path>`
- `<Rect>`